

August 12, 2026

Molina Healthcare of South Carolina
Provider Appeals Department

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Oretha Langworth (MRN MUSC3077563), Claim MUSC-20260428-FDBA-1

Patient	Oretha Langworth (DOB 1926-06-06)
MRN	MUSC3077563
Member ID / Group	MOL620059768 / GRP-33335
Claim number	MUSC-20260428-FDBA-1
Date of service	2026-04-28
Procedure billed	CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity
Primary diagnosis	J06.9 — Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified
Denied amount	\$602.71
Denial code	CARC 96 / RARC N130 — Non-covered charge(s).
Appeal deadline	2026-09-11

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health respectfully submits this first-level appeal on behalf of Oretha Langworth (Member ID: MOL620059768) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-20260428-FDBA-1, dated April 28, 2026, and submitted May 17, 2026. Molina Healthcare of South Carolina denied the claim in full on June 13, 2026, citing CARC 96 ("Non-covered charge(s)") and RARC N130 ("Consult plan benefit documents/guidelines for information about restrictions for this service"), with the payer remark that "Service is excluded under the member's plan benefit document." The billed amount of \$602.71 remains unpaid. MUSC Health contends that this denial is not supported by the clinical facts of the encounter and respectfully requests reversal and payment at the allowed amount of \$294.45.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Ms. Langworth is a 100-year-old established female patient with a documented history of active epilepsy and seizure disorder (G40.909, onset recorded from birth) and active Alzheimer's disease, among other conditions. She was seen on April 28, 2026, by Dr. Priya N. Raghavan, MD (NPI 1669504132) at MUSC Health Rutledge Tower Ambulatory Care, an on-campus outpatient hospital facility (Place of Service 22). The visit was billed as CPT 99214, an established patient office or outpatient visit of moderate complexity, with a primary diagnosis of acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified (J06.9), and a secondary diagnosis of epilepsy, unspecified, not intractable (G40.909). Given Ms. Langworth's age, her active seizure disorder requiring ongoing management, and her multiple comorbidities, an evaluation and management visit of moderate complexity is clinically consistent with the documented diagnoses.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The denial characterizes CPT 99214 as a non-covered service excluded under the member's plan benefit document. However, Molina Healthcare of South Carolina administers a Medicaid managed care plan under contract with the South Carolina Department of Health and Human Services. Outpatient evaluation and management services, including established patient office visits, are a standard covered benefit under South Carolina Medicaid and are not categorically excludable for an enrolled beneficiary receiving medically necessary care. CPT 99214 is a widely recognized, standard evaluation and management code applicable to established outpatient visits of moderate complexity. The service was rendered by a qualified physician at an enrolled facility during an active coverage period (January 1, 2024, through December 31, 2026), and there is no clinical or contractual basis apparent in the remittance advice to support exclusion of this service category for this member.

The denial notice directs the provider to consult plan benefit documents but does not identify a specific exclusion provision applicable to this service or this patient's circumstances. A blanket non-covered determination without citation of a specific applicable exclusion does not constitute adequate justification under generally accepted managed care appeal standards and Medicaid managed care due process requirements. MUSC Health has not been provided sufficient information to understand why a routine outpatient evaluation and management visit for an established patient with active, documented medical conditions would be excluded from coverage.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that Molina Healthcare of South Carolina conduct a thorough review of this appeal, identify with specificity any plan provision relied upon to exclude CPT 99214 for this member and date of service, and reverse the denial. Upon reversal, we request that payment be issued at the allowed amount of \$294.45 in accordance with the contracted fee schedule. If Molina determines that additional clinical documentation is required to support this appeal, MUSC Health will promptly provide any records upon request. This appeal is submitted within the 90-day appeal deadline of September 11, 2026, as specified on the remittance advice.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

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Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record